

Data Sources and Editorial Methodology

Effective date: July 17, 2026

1. Purpose

Black Swan: War Impact Map is an independent open-source information visualisation project published by GY Signal Studio.

Its purpose is to organise publicly reported information concerning how Russia's war affects Russia itself and related geographic areas.

The project is intended to make dispersed public reporting easier to explore through a map-based interface.

2. Types of Sources

Black Swan may use or reference:

- official statements issued by governments or public authorities;
- statements by military or security institutions;
- established international, national, regional, or local media;
- investigative journalism;
- publicly accessible databases;
- satellite-imagery reporting;
- company disclosures;
- court or procurement records;
- public social-media posts;
- open-source research;
- encyclopaedic and reference resources;
- sanctions and economic data;
- other publicly accessible materials.

The presence of a source does not mean that GY Signal Studio endorses the source's broader editorial position.

3. Source Attribution

Entries should, where reasonably available, include:

- source name;
- source link;
- publication date;
- event date;
- access or retrieval date;
- brief original summary;
- relevant qualification or uncertainty.

Where a report relies on an official claim, the entry should attribute the claim to the issuing organisation.

Preferred wording:

“The General Staff of Ukraine reported that the facility was struck.”

Avoided wording, unless independently established:

“The facility was destroyed.”

An official statement confirms that the organisation made the statement. It does not automatically establish that every detail of the underlying event has been independently verified.

4. Verification Levels

Black Swan may use editorial statuses such as:

Reported

The event or claim has been published by at least one identifiable public source.

Corroborated

Material aspects of the event are supported by multiple reasonably independent sources, credible visual evidence, official confirmation, or another meaningful form of corroboration.

Disputed

Material details are challenged by credible sources or materially inconsistent accounts exist.

Corrected

Previously displayed information has been materially amended following new evidence or identification of an error.

Unconfirmed

The information is relevant but lacks sufficient independent confirmation.

Status labels are editorial tools and do not represent legal or scientific certainty.

5. Inclusion Criteria

An event may be included when:

- it falls within the geographic and thematic scope of the App;
- an identifiable public source exists;
- the report has sufficient informational value;

- publication would not create an unreasonable privacy or safety risk;
- the information can be summarised without unlawfully copying protected material.

Inclusion means that the matter was publicly reported. It does not mean that GY Signal Studio independently verified every detail.

6. Geographic Accuracy

Coordinates may represent:

- an exact publicly known location;
- the approximate centre of a city or municipality;
- a general industrial area;
- a broader administrative region;
- a deliberately generalised location.

Locations may be approximate because of:

- incomplete reporting;
- conflicting source descriptions;
- safety considerations;
- protection of individuals;
- lack of independently verifiable coordinates;
- changes in administrative boundaries.

The App must not be treated as a precision-navigation or targeting tool.

7. Dates and Times

Dates may refer to:

- the date an event occurred;
- the date it was first publicly reported;
- the date an official statement was issued;
- an approximate period where the exact date is uncertain.

Where sources disagree, the App may display an approximate date or note the discrepancy.

8. Casualties and Damage Estimates

Casualty figures, financial losses, production losses, infrastructure damage, and other quantitative estimates are especially vulnerable to:

- incomplete access;
- propaganda;
- delayed reporting;
- inconsistent definitions;
- double counting;
- later revisions.

Where practical, figures should be attributed to the source and described as estimates rather than established facts.

9. Economic and Regional Data

Regional economic indicators may include:

- budget deficit or surplus;
- public debt;
- changes in public debt;
- tax revenues;
- industrial output;
- fuel shortages;
- credit stress;
- bankruptcies;
- labour-market pressure;
- sanctions exposure;
- infrastructure disruption.

Different sources may use different accounting periods, definitions, currencies, reporting dates, and revision methods.

Comparisons should identify the relevant period and unit wherever possible.

10. Wikipedia and Reference Sources

Wikipedia and similar reference resources may be used to:

- identify relevant events;
- locate source material;
- understand chronology;
- obtain introductory context.

Where practical, Black Swan should follow the underlying citations and cite the original source rather than relying solely on Wikipedia.

Text from Wikipedia or other licensed sources must not be copied without complying with the applicable licence and attribution requirements.

11. Copyright Approach

Black Swan aims to provide:

- original short summaries;
- factual descriptions;
- limited quotations only where necessary;
- links to the original publication;
- proper attribution.

The App does not aim to reproduce full news articles or substitute for the original source.

Photographs, videos, logos, maps, and other protected materials should be used only where permission, licence, public-domain status, or another lawful basis exists.

12. Editorial Independence

GY Signal Studio independently determines:

- which events to include;
- how events are categorised;
- how sources are described;
- which claims require qualification;
- whether a correction is appropriate;
- whether an entry presents an unreasonable safety or privacy risk.

No external organisation is entitled to control inclusion merely because it is linked, cited, criticised, or referenced.

13. Corrections Policy

Credible error reports are reviewed as resources permit.

Possible actions include:

- correcting factual wording;
- changing a date;
- adjusting a location;
- replacing a broken source;
- adding a competing account;
- changing verification status;
- removing unsupported information;
- noting that a prior version was corrected.

Correction requests should be sent to:

gysignalstudio.dev@gmail.com

The message should identify:

- the relevant map entry;
- the disputed statement;
- supporting evidence;
- the requested correction.

14. Privacy and Safety Considerations

Black Swan should avoid publishing unnecessary personal information about private individuals.

The App should not intentionally publish:

- private addresses of individuals;

- private contact details;
- personal identity documents;
- information that would unnecessarily expose a private person to harm;
- non-public sensitive personal data.

Public-interest reporting concerning public officials, company representatives, military officials, or publicly identified individuals may be included where lawful and relevant.

15. No Guarantee of Completeness

Black Swan cannot include every relevant event or source.

Absence from the map does not mean:

- an event did not occur;
- a region was unaffected;
- a claim is false;
- an incident was insignificant.

The database reflects available editorial resources, source availability, and the project's defined scope.

16. Contact

GY Signal Studio

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About Black Swan

Black Swan is an independent OSINT and open-source media visualisation project that maps publicly reported effects of Russia's war inside Russia and related regions.

Entries are based on identifiable public sources. Inclusion means that an event or claim was publicly reported; it does not mean that GY Signal Studio independently verified every detail.

Black Swan is unofficial and is not affiliated with any government, armed force, intelligence agency, charity, media organisation, or Google.

Short In-App Disclaimer

Black Swan visualises publicly reported information from third-party sources.

Dates, locations, damage estimates, casualty figures, and attribution may be incomplete, approximate, disputed, or later corrected.

The App is not an official record, real-time operational map, intelligence assessment, military-planning tool, or emergency-warning service.

Open each event to review its cited sources.

Event Card Disclaimer

This entry summarises publicly reported information.

Inclusion does not mean that GY Signal Studio independently verified every detail. Review the cited source and any displayed verification status.

External Link Notice

You are leaving Black Swan and opening a third-party website.

GY Signal Studio does not control the website's content, privacy practices, security, availability, or subsequent changes.

Support Ukraine Notice

The links in this section lead to independent third-party organisations supporting Ukraine.

GY Signal Studio does not process donations, receive your payment details, or provide digital App benefits in exchange for external donations.

Verify the recipient and payment details on the organisation's official website before completing a transaction.

Privacy Choices Label

Privacy Choices

Review or change your advertising and privacy consent preferences.

Availability of particular choices depends on your region and applicable law.

Remove Ads Description

Remove Ads

One-time purchase. No subscription.

The purchase is processed by Google Play and linked to your Google Play account. You may restore it on supported devices using the same account.

The final local price is displayed by Google Play.

Restore Purchases Text

Restore Purchases

Check Google Play for a previously completed Remove Ads purchase associated with the current Google Play account.

No additional payment will be made by using this function.

Report an Error Text

Found an inaccurate date, location, category, source, or description?

Send the event name, the disputed information, and supporting sources to:

`gysignalstudio.dev@gmail.com`

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Publisher Attribution

Black Swan: War Impact Map is published by **GY Signal Studio**, an independent developer project operated by Yurii Gevtsi in Ukraine.

Google Play Independence Disclaimer

Black Swan is an independent and unofficial application.

It is not affiliated with or endorsed by any government, military organisation, intelligence agency, charity, media organisation, source publisher, or Google.

Recommended Website Footer

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Black Swan is an independent informational project.

Contact: gysignalstudio.dev@gmail.com